



Pipefitter

pipefitter • 4-5 year apprenticeship

\$60K-\$85K / yr

THE TRADE

Assemble and install high-pressure pipe systems for steam, chemicals, and gases in power plants, refineries, and industrial facilities. Pipefitting is among the highest-paid trades on the board, with a structured 4-5 year UA apprenticeship and serious earning power once you weld-certs stack.

SALARY & TRAINING

JOURNEYMAN BAND (SITE FIGURE — SAME AS QUIZ RESULT & TRADES PAGE)

\$60K-\$85K

BLS median \$59,880 — plumbers & pipefitters (blog-cited) • apprentice 4-5 yr • top entry-level ceiling on the board

THE PATH: FROM RESEARCH TO HIRED

01 RESEARCH Compare training routes, union vs non-union, and local demand

02 TRAIN Trade school / pre-apprenticeship — start with OSHA 10

03 HANDS-ON Apprentice years: log hours, earn raises to 80-90% of scale

04 CERTIFIED Pass the journeyman or industry certification exam

05 HIRED Journey-level pay — specialize, stack certs, own the shop

Every apprentice track pays from day one — typical start is 40-50% of journey scale with scheduled raises every year. Each step above is fully mapped on the TradeLift Getting Started guide and the site's resources page.



REQUIRED CERTIFICATIONS & CREDENTIALS

UA pipefitter / steamfitter apprenticeship

YOUR FIRST 12 WEEKS — THE ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Take the TradeLift quiz to confirm fit
- ☐ Earn your OSHA 10 online
- ☐ Get First Aid/CPR certified
- ☐ Draft a one-page trade resume
- ☐ Call a local UA steamfitters' hall
- ☐ Search apprenticeship.gov pipefitting
- ☐ Buy a pipe wrench set + torpedo level
- ☐ Practice reading P&IDs and drawings
- ☐ Meet a working pipefitter for advice
- ☐ Apply to 2-3 union programs
- ☐ Prep the math + mechanical aptitude test
- ☐ Shadow a fitter if the hall allows it

Full career steps, certifications, and tool guides: <https://tradelift.surge.sh/getting-started.html>